

Budget & Expenditure

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Q: Considering that the requirements for RPTC are based estimates, please provide details on the methodology and procedures used to propose resource requirements and the allocation between different entities.

DESA is requested to provide the response based on the verbal responses from Mr. Harris.

DESA: The distribution of resources under RPTC is proposed by the Secretary-General as reflected in the budget fascicle that is then subject to review by the ACABQ and the Fifth Committee who have the authority to make recommendations to the General Assembly prior to the adoption of the budget. Each entity determines the most appropriate distribution of resources to respond adequately to the requests of Member States for assistance. Such redeployments may be considered when preparing succeeding budget proposals if the trends in demand justify such changes.

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Q: What is the difference between the technical cooperation you provide through the implementing agencies and the expertise provided by the Agencies themselves in helping member states meet the SDGs? PPBD to clarify on what is meant by the question YI

DESA is requested to provide the response based on the verbal responses from Mr. Harris.

(PPBD) As I recall the Q and A session, the question was asking for the difference between the work that agency (I understand this to mean implementing entity), such as DESA, implements using the RPTC funds and the work which is done through the respective sections programme budget. Mr. Harris had provided a verbal response to outline how the DESA RPTC section 23 work complements the work that DESA undertakes through section 9. In this response we will use DESA as an example and explain the different approaches for the response driven short term RPTC type of work, and the longer term programmatic activities under DESA.

DESA: in the past the Committee asked a similar question in context of UNCTAD. Could we use this example?

The funds approved for DESA under section 9 (International cooperation for development) of the regular budget support the costs of the DESA staff that provide normative and analytical expertise and support intergovernmental bodies and the processes that address the economic, social and environmental dimensions of sustainable development. Each subprogramme, with exception of subprogramme 1 (Intergovernmental support and coordination for sustainable development) has capacity development component embedded and undertake capacity development work in their expertise and knowledge. s necessary expertise and knowledge, translated into research on interrelated issues mentioned above, and is also being used to develop the curriculum of the course, taking into consideration regional and national specificities. UNCTAD staff, funded through section 12,

provide the training for government officials and policy practitioners in Geneva and in various countries and regions. This complementarity between the funds under section 12 and the RPTC funds ensures that UNCTAD's cutting-edge evidence-based analysis and research translates into capacity building and advice, helping countries achieve their development goals and benefit from global trade.

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DESA: in the past the Committee asked a similar question in context of UNCTAD. Could we use this example?

An example of UNCTAD: UNCTAD uses the RPTC resources to focus on supporting the delivery of the UNCTAD course on key issues on the international economic agenda (called P166 courses). This

flagship programme focuses on the links between trade, finance, investment, technology and development, and assesses the approaches required to potentially generate development gains from trade and investment. RPTC resources ensure the delivery of the courses through supporting the costs of travel of participants from the developing countries and economies in transition and costs associated with travel of staff [as experts or instructors] and general operating expenses such as rental of conference rooms, accommodations and simultaneous interpretation.

The funds approved for UNTAD under section 12 (Trade and Development) of the regular budget support the costs of the UNCTAD staff that provide necessary expertise and knowledge, translated into research on interrelated issues mentioned above, and is also being used to develop the curriculum of the course, taking into consideration regional and national specificities. UNCTAD staff, funded through section 12, provide the training for government officials and policy practitioners in Geneva and in various countries and regions. This complementarity between the funds under section 12 and the RPTC funds ensures that UNCTAD's cutting-edge evidence-based analysis and research translates into capacity building and advice, helping countries achieve their development goals and benefit from global trade.

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Q: In regard to the planned projects please provide information on the distribution, elaborate on the timeline, when those distributions occur exactly in terms of project implementation.

39.1 Please refer to the list of planned projects and timelines provided in the response to question 6, above.

39.2 In terms of the distributions of resources among the sub-programmes at the entity level, using DESA as an example, DESA's responses are coordinated from the activity formulation stage by the Capacity Development Programme Management Office in line with the guiding principles, criteria, as outlined in paragraph 23.13 of the budget report, availability of in-house expertise and the priorities of the Department.

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